YEAR 12 BUSINESS STUDIES

HSC Trial Revision Workbook — Complete Core Syllabus (RIPS Framework)

Student Name: _____	**Class:** Year 12 Business Studies
Target 1 (Marketing): Monday, 20 July 2026	**Target 2 (Full Portfolio):** Monday, 10 August 2026

TOPIC 1: MARKETING (RIPS FRAMEWORK)

ROLE OF MARKETING

R1 Strategic role of marketing goods and services
Explain profit maximisation, customer retention, and strategic growth goals...

R2 Interdependence with other key business functions
Explain how Marketing relies on Operations, Finance, and HR...

R3 Production, selling, and marketing approaches
Trace the evolution from production focus ➔ selling focus ➔ customer-centric marketing focus...

R4 Types of markets (Resource, Industrial, Intermediate, Consumer, Mass, Niche)
Define each market type and identify McDonald's operations within consumer & franchisor markets...

INFLUENCES ON MARKETING

I1 Factors influencing customer choice (Psychological, Sociocultural, Economic, Government)
Analyze how motives, reference groups, inflation, and government health rules shape choices...

I2 Consumer laws (Deceptive advertising, Price discrimination, Implied conditions, Warranties)
Explain requirements under Australian Consumer Law (ACL)...

I3 Ethical influences (Truth, Accuracy/Good taste, Health impact products, Fair competition, Sugging)
Discuss advertising to children, ethical competition, and disguised market research (sugging)...

MARKETING PROCESSES

P1 Situational Analysis (SWOT & Product Life Cycle)
Analyze McDonald's SWOT and map menu items to PLC stages (Intro, Growth, Maturity, Decline)...

P2 Market research, Objectives, & Target markets
Detail primary vs secondary data, setting objectives, and identifying primary/secondary markets...

P3 Developing strategies, Implementation, Monitoring & Controlling
Explain financial forecasting, comparing actual vs planned results, and revising strategies...

MARKETING STRATEGIES

S1 Market segmentation, Differentiation & Positioning
How does McDonald's segment (demographic, geographic) and position its brand value?

S2 Products (Branding & Packaging) & Price Strategies
Detail golden arches branding, pricing methods (cost/market/competition), and pricing strategies...

S3 Promotion Mix & Place / Distribution Channels
Outline advertising, sales promotion, PR, channel choices (intensive), and delivery logistics...

S4 3 Additional Ps (People, Processes, Physical Evidence) & E-Marketing
Explain customer service, order standardization, store layout, and MyMaccas app marketing...

S5 Global Marketing (Standardisation vs Customisation)
Analyze global branding (Big Mac) vs local menu customisation (McSpicy, Halal items)...

TOPIC 2: OPERATIONS (RIPS FRAMEWORK)

ROLE OF OPERATIONS

R1 Strategic role of operations (Cost leadership vs Good/Service differentiation)
Explain cost leadership via bulk buying & kitchen efficiency alongside product differentiation...

R2 Goods and services in different industries & Interdependence
Explain McDonald's hybrid model: tangible fast-food items + immediate perishable service...

INFLUENCES ON OPERATIONS

I1 Globalisation, Technology, Quality expectations, Cost competition
Detail global supply chains, automated kitchen tech, and customer quality expectations...

I2 Government policies, Legal regulation, Sustainability & CSR
Contrast legal compliance vs ethical responsibilities (paper straws, RSPCA chicken sourcing)...

OPERATIONS PROCESSES

P1 Transformed Inputs vs Transforming Inputs
Transformed (ingredients, info, customers) vs Transforming (crew labor, kitchen facilities)...

P2 Transformation processes (V4, Sequencing & Scheduling, Layout, Monitoring)
Analyze Volume, Variety, Variation, Visibility (V4), Gantt charts, assembly line layouts...

P3 Outputs (Customer service & Warranties)
Order accuracy guarantees, temperature checks, and fast-food warranties...

OPERATIONS STRATEGIES

S1 Performance objectives (Quality, Speed, Dependability, Flexibility, Customisation, Cost)
Evaluate how McDonald's balances speed and cost minimisation with food quality...

S2 Technology (Established vs Leading-Edge)
Established (drink dispensers, POS) vs Leading-Edge (self-order kiosks, AI drive-thru, app integration)...

S3 Inventory Management (FIFO, LIFO, JIT) & Quality Management
Explain FIFO and Just-In-Time (JIT) storage controls alongside Quality Assurance...

S4 Overcoming resistance to change & Global Factors
Financial equipment costs, retraining, overcoming inertia, global sourcing, economies of scale...

💰 TOPIC 3: FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT (RIPS FRAMEWORK)

ROLE & INFLUENCES ON FINANCE

R1 Strategic role & Financial Objectives (PLEGS)
Explain the strategic conflict between Profitability, Liquidity, Efficiency, Growth, and Solvency...

I1 Sources of Finance: Internal vs External (Debt & Equity)
Retained profits vs Short/Long term debt (overdraft, leasing) vs Equity (shares, private equity)...

I2 Financial Institutions, Government (ASIC, Tax) & Global Markets
Banks, ASX, ASIC reporting requirements, company tax, interest rates, and global economic outlook...

FINANCIAL PROCESSES & RATIOS

MCDONALD'S FRANCHISE FINANCIAL DATA STATEMENT ($ AUD)	
Total Sales Revenue: $1,000,000	Cost of Goods Sold (COGS): $600,000
Gross Profit: $400,000	Current Assets: $150,000
Current Liabilities: $50,000	Total Debt (Liabilities): $200,000
Total Equity: $200,000	Net Profit: $150,000

P1 Ratio Calculation 1: Liquidity Ratio (Current Ratio = Current Assets ÷ Current Liabilities)
Calculate result ($150,000 ÷ $50,000) and assess whether short-term debt capacity is healthy:

P2 Ratio Calculation 2: Solvency / Gearing Ratio (Debt to Equity = Total Liabilities ÷ Total Equity)
Calculate result ($200,000 ÷ $200,000) and assess financial gearing risk:

P3 Ratio Calculation 3: Gross Profit Ratio ([Gross Profit ÷ Sales] × 100)
Calculate result ([$400,000 ÷ $1,000,000] × 100) and assess mark-up strength:

FINANCIAL STRATEGIES

S1 Cash Flow & Working Capital Management
Strategies: distribution of payments, discounts, leasing, sale & leaseback, factoring...

S2 Profitability Management & Global Financial Strategies
Cost controls (fixed/variable), cost centres, exchange rate hedging, international payment methods...

TOPIC 4: HUMAN RESOURCES (RIPSE FRAMEWORK)

ROLE & INFLUENCES ON HR

R1 Strategic role of HR, Interdependence & Outsourcing
Aligning crew training with growth goals, kitchen rosters with marketing sales, domestic/global outsourcing...

I1 Stakeholders, Legal Framework, WHS & EEO
Employers, SDA union, Fast Food Award 2020, WHS Act kitchen safety, Equal Employment Opportunity...

I2 Economic, Technological & Social Influences
Economic cycles, app order tech replacing cashiers, casualisation of workforce, living standards...

HR PROCESSES (THE HR CYCLE)

P1 Acquisition (Recruitment & Selection)
Online recruitment, digital applications, group interview selection...

P2 Development (Training & Induction)
On-the-job station checklists, Hamburger University manager courses...

P3 Maintenance (Monetary & Non-monetary Rewards)
Award rates, store discounts, Employee of the Month recognition...

P4 Separation (Voluntary & Involuntary)
Managing high casual turnover rates, exit procedures, redundancy rules...

HR STRATEGIES & DISPUTE RESOLUTION

S1 Leadership Styles, Job Design, Recruitment & Performance
Autocratic kitchen leadership, specific station job design, developmental feedback...

S2 Workplace Disputes Resolution
Detail Grievance Procedures ➔ Mediation / Conciliation ➔ Fair Work Commission (FWC) Arbitration...

EFFECTIVENESS OF HUMAN RESOURCE MANAGEMENT

E1 Indicators: Corporate Culture & KPI Benchmarking
Explain how positive corporate culture and benchmarking KPIs indicate HR effectiveness...

E2 Indicators: Turnover, Absenteeism, Accidents, Disputation & Satisfaction
Analyze turnover rates, absence trends, kitchen injury rates, grievance levels, and worker survey satisfaction...

TOPIC 5: HSC EXAM PEEL WRITING SCAFFOLD

HSC Business Studies PEEL Structure Guide

P - Point: *Clear topic sentence answering the question with syllabus terminology.*
E - Explain: *Cause-and-effect explanation of economic/business theory.*
E - Evidence: *Concrete real-world data/facts from McDonald's case study.*
L - Link: *Connect back to business objectives (profitability, cost minimisation, competitive advantage).*

Practice Question Draft Response Area

Question Selected: Explain how McDonald's uses operations strategies to gain a competitive advantage. (8 Marks)